

Illustrative Four-Square constitutional overlay only — not upstream Django governance.

PROJECT CONSTITUTION / CONTRACT / LETTERHEAD

FOUR-SQUARE RELEASE LINEAGE

main1 = repository first commit / immutable root reference

SPEC spec-v1.2	CODE code-v1.2	DOCS docs-v1.2	MEMORY memory-v1.2
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SPEC and MEMORY are fixed. The two middle lanes are project-defined and **SHOULD** remain stable across versions.

CONSTITUTIONAL LANGUAGE

MUST / MUST NOT binding law	SHALL / SHALL NOT constitutional alias	SHOULD / SHOULD NOT strong guidance	MAY permitted option	EXCEPTION / WAIVER explicit departure
MISSION Provide a coherent framework for building database-backed web applications with mature integrated facilities.		CORE PRINCIPLE CODE and DOCS SHOULD remain aligned; deviations SHOULD be explicit.		BOUNDARY Application business logic and deployment policy remain with consuming projects.

CONSTITUTIONAL HIERARCHY / FORMS

CONSTITUTION → ARTICLES / LAWS → CONTRACTS → POLICIES → GUARDRAILS → RECOMMENDED PRACTICES → CHECKLISTS

The form label does not determine force; the normative keyword does.

ARTICLES / LAWS / CONTRACTS / GUARDRAILS

ID	FORM	FORCE	CLAUSE
D1	LAW	MUST	Declared public behavior MUST have implementation evidence and aligned developer guidance.
D2	GUARDRAIL	MUST NOT	DOCS MUST NOT knowingly describe behavior unsupported by accepted CODE.
D3	POLICY	SHOULD	Compatibility changes SHOULD record affected versions and migration guidance.
D4	CONTRACT	MUST	Release evidence MUST distinguish proven behavior from illustrative material.
D5	MEMORY	MUST NOT	MEMORY MUST NOT create new framework law unless promoted into SPEC.

CONFORMANCE / EXCEPTION DECLARATION

CONFORMANT	CONFORMANT WITH EXCEPTION	NON-CONFORMANT	NOT YET PROVEN
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A **MUST** / **MUST NOT** deviation **MUST** be visible. An **EXCEPTION** / **WAIVER** **MUST** identify clause, scope, owner, rationale, evidence and review/expiry condition where applicable.

RELEASE LAW

Draft ≠ Tested ≠ Accepted ≠ Released. Claims **MUST** be scoped to evidence actually validated. A release **MUST NOT** hide unresolved binding violations. One version, four squares, all green.

PAGE 2 — GOVERNANCE / DEVELOPMENT / EXCEPTIONS

Use when project complexity requires more than the one-page constitutional identity.

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DEVELOPMENT GOVERNANCE — RECOMMENDED CHECKLIST

- ☐ Material work **SHOULD** use a checklist or equivalent visible plan.
- ☐ Each binding clause **SHOULD** map to a verification item and observable evidence.
- ☐ Agents **MAY** perform Discover → Plan → Execute → Observe → Verify → Record with defined responsibilities.
- ☐ Agents **MUST NOT** reinterpret or waive constitutional law without explicit authority.
- ☐ Proven libraries, binaries, scripts, documents, services, datasets, models, plugins and utilities **SHOULD** be evaluated before new core work.

EXCEPTION / WAIVER PROTOCOL

CLAUSE	SCOPE	OWNER	RATIONALE	EVIDENCE	REVIEW / EXPIRY
[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]	[REQUIRED]

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